

Le Corbusier

Swiss artist, architect and urban planner Le Corbusier (1887–1965) blended modernism with bold expression. An early user of rough-cast concrete, he helped instigate the international style. Born Charles-Édouard Jeanneret-Gris (the pseudonym came in 1920), he moved to Paris after the war and met the Cubist painter Amédée Ozenfant (1886–1966). They created Purism, a new art movement, publishing a manifesto and a journal, *L'Esprit Nouveau*. In 1922, Le Corbusier opened a practice with his cousin Pierre Jeanneret (1896–1967), and they co-designed buildings and furniture for 40 years. The manifesto stated his 'five points of architecture' – supporting pilotis (piers), roof gardens, open-plan interiors, ornament-free façades, and full-length horizontal windows – and his designs bore them out. Following his own principle that 'a house is a machine for living in', he created fluent, light-filled interiors in such designs as Citrohan House in Stuttgart (1922) and Villa Savoye, Paris (opposite, 1928–31). His Marseille housing complex, Unité d'Habitation (1952), is a landmark in brutalist architecture.

